

OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

POLICY

SECTION 6: Patient Care **POLICY: 6.059**

SUBJECT: Animals at Oregon State Hospital

POINT PERSON: Director of Treatment Services

APPROVED: Sara Walker, MD  **DATE: MAY 15, 2023**
Interim Superintendent

SELECT ONE: ☐ New policy ☐ Minor/technical revision of existing policy
☐ Reaffirmation of existing policy ☒ Major revision of existing policy

I. PURPOSE AND APPLICABILITY

- A. This policy defines requirements and procedures for animals and animal handlers visiting Oregon State Hospital (OSH).
- B. This policy applies to:
 - 1. Visiting animals including animal-assisted therapy (AAT)/animal-assisted activities (AAA) animals, visitor-handled animals, Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) service animals, and service animals in training.
 - 2. Handlers bringing animals into OSH.
 - 3. All OSH staff and patients.

II. POLICY

- A. OSH recognizes the benefits of human-animal interactions as therapeutic interventions in structured therapist-led groups, individual sessions, and informal encounters.
- B. An animal must be approved per Procedures A before it may enter an OSH building.
- C. Approval for an animal may be revoked at any time per Procedures A for situations including, but not limited to:
 - 1. If the animal does not meet the identified patient or hospital needs,
 - 2. If there are infection control issues, and/or

3. If there is a complaint or incident involving health or safety of the animal or animal/handler team.
- D. There must be a business need for an animal to be in the hospital. For the purposes of this policy, justified business needs include:
 1. AAT/AAA
 2. Patient visitation
 3. An approved Americans with Disabilities Act of 1991 (ADA) accommodation.
 - a. A service animal may be allowed at OSH in accordance with ADA, unless the presence of the animal poses a direct threat to other persons or fundamentally disrupts the nature of hospital services.
 - b. Staff must have an approved ADA accommodation through HR per Procedures A for a service animal prior to bringing the animal into an OSH building.
 4. Vocational service dog training
- E. All animals and animal handlers on an OSH campus are subject to the following guidelines:
 1. Animals must be an approved domesticated species to visit OSH. Approved domesticated species include dogs and cats only.
 - a. A wild or exotic animal is not allowed in an OSH building.
 2. Any animal outside of the approved domesticated species list requires Chief Medical Officer (CMO) approval to visit OSH.
 - a. Exception reviews must be requested using the Handler/Animal Exceptions Request Form (Attachment E) through the approving manager, or designee.
 3. All animals must continue to adhere to requirements described in Procedures A.
 4. A handler who has to step away from the animal temporarily must have a designated staff with the animal at all times who is responsible for meeting the animal's needs.
 5. An animal may not be left unattended in a vehicle on an OSH campus (see OSH Policy and Procedure 8.023, "Parking and Parking Registration").

6. Staff must follow OSH policy 8.006, "Vehicle Usage," and Oregon Administrative Rule §125-155-0420 relating to state vehicle use when driving an animal in a state car.
7. Animals are not permitted in the following locations;
 - a. Food preparation, storage areas, or eating areas (including patient meals)
 - b. Seclusion or restraint areas
 - c. Medication rooms, medical clinic, and exam rooms
 - d. Linen and laundry areas
8. The CMO or Superintendent may authorize animals in eating areas for patient visitation or AAT.
 - a. This authorization is effective for the requested visitation or treatment area until revoked by the Superintendent, CMO or Designee.
 - b. This applies to standard visitation or treatment areas only; all other animal exceptions must follow the exceptions process outlined in Attachment E.
9. An animal that has not been spayed must not be in active estrus during a visit to OSH. Exceptions may be made for service animals or service animals in the OSH training program.
10. CMO (or designee) review and response to an exception request must be completed within five business days of receipt from the approving manager (or designee).
- F. Staff must notify staff and patients in locations where they may come in contact with the animal prior to coming into contact with units, treatment malls, or respite locations, per Procedure B.
- G. Documentation requirements must be followed per Procedures B.
- H. Staff who are unable to be in the presence of animals are encouraged to self-disclose this information to their direct supervisor(s) in order to support planning around respite schedules/locations, as well as animal-assisted interventions.
- I. In the event of an incident (*e.g.*, animal to human bite, severe allergic reaction of patient or staff, other injury, or property damage), follow Procedures A.
- J. All handlers and animals approved to be at OSH are required to be entered into the Centralized Personnel Database (CPD) and are subject to regular review at least annually by the department manager (or designee), per Procedures B.

- K. Vocational Services establishes and oversees the OSH program for service animals in training per department protocols.
- L. Visitors bringing animals to OSH must adhere to this policy, OSH policy 8.026, "Visitors to Patients," and OSH policy 4.005, "Visitor Cottage."
- M. A volunteer animal handler must be registered with Volunteer Services according to OSH policy 5.018, "Volunteers."
- N. OSH follows all applicable regulations, including federal and state statutes and rules; Oregon Department of Administrative Services (DAS), Shared Services, and Oregon Health Authority (OHA) policies; and relevant accreditation standards. Such regulations supersede the provisions of this policy unless this policy is more restrictive.
- O. Staff who fail to comply with this policy or related policy attachments or protocols may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

III. DEFINITIONS

- A. "Animal-assisted activities (AAA)" are activities designed to provide opportunities for motivational, educational, recreational, or therapeutic benefits to enhance quality of life. AAA are delivered by specially trained professionals, paraprofessionals, or volunteers in association with animals that have, at minimum, an American Kennel Club Canine Good Citizen (CGC) certification. Animal-Assisted Activities do not have specific treatment goals planned for each visit.
- B. "Animal-assisted therapy (AAT)" is a goal-oriented, planned, structured, and documented therapeutic intervention directed by a qualified professional or therapist in conjunction with a therapy animal as part of that person's profession.
- C. "Code Blue" is as defined in OSH policy 8.038, "Code Blue Medical Emergency." Code Blue means a request for immediate response to any apparent emergency medical condition that could be either potentially life threatening or life altering.
- D. "Handler" means a person responsible for the animal during the time they are on an Oregon State Hospital (OSH) campus.
 - 1. "Visiting animal handler" refers to the owner or individual who takes responsibility for a visiting animal while on OSH property.
 - 2. "Volunteer animal handler" means approved OSH volunteers' handling animals
 - 3. "Therapy handler" means a person handling a therapy animal.

- E. "Respite" means time for the animal away from the animal-assisted activity.
- F. "Service animal (Americans with Disabilities Act [ADA] animal)" means any guide dog, signal dog, or other animal individually trained to do work or perform tasks for the benefit of an individual with a disability, including, but not limited to guiding an individual with impaired vision, alerting an individual with impaired hearing to intruders or sounds, providing minimal protection or rescue work, pulling a wheelchair, or fetching dropped items. When an animal meets this definition, the animal is considered a service animal under the ADA, regardless of whether the animal has been licensed or certified by a state or local government.
- G. "Service animal in training" means an animal that is in the developmental process of structured Vocational Services training program that provides a service for an individual with specific identified needs.
- H. "Staff" includes employees, volunteers, trainees, interns, contractors, vendors, and other state employees assigned to work at OSH.
- I. "Therapy animal" means an animal who is, at minimum, certified (e.g., American Kennel Club CGC), but may also be registered by one of the national or international animal therapy programs (e.g., Pet Partners) and which is accompanied by a handler.
- J. "Visitor-handled animal," means an animal accompanied by an approved visiting animal handler attending visitation(s) with OSH patients.

IV. PROCEDURES

- Procedures A Approval and Incident Process
- Procedures B Handler and Therapy Animal Oversight
- Attachment A AAT/AAA: Handler and Animal Application
- Attachment B Visitation: Handler and Animal Application
- Attachment C AAT/AAA Handler/Animal Team Expectations/Acknowledgement
- Attachment D Visitor Expectations and Acknowledgments
- Attachment E Handler/Animal Exceptions Request Form

V. RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS

- 1.003 Incident Reporting
- 2.012 Patient Safety Events, Including Sentinel Events
- 4.005 Visitor Cottage

5.011 Return to Work of Staff Injured on the Job

5.012 Injury or Illness Reporting

5.018 Volunteers

8.002 Emergency Care Provided by OSH

8.006 Vehicle Usage

8.023 Parking and Parking Registration

8.026 Visitors to Patients

8.038 Code Blue Medical Emergency

8.042 Injured Staff Transportation

Vocational Services protocol – Service Animals

VI. REFERENCES

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